



VERIFICATION METHODOLOGY

The Evidence Standard for ESG and Impact Claims

Version 1.0

April 2026

1. Purpose and Scope

Purpose

The Synerxus Verification Methodology defines the process for converting operational activity into structured, traceable evidence that supports ESG reporting, impact measurement, third-party review, and assurance preparation.

Scope

This methodology covers:

Activity verification across corporate volunteering, NGO programs, and community initiatives.

Outcome confirmation by independent third parties including NGOs, employers, and beneficiaries.

Evidence collection aligned with CSRD, ESRS, GRI, ISAE 3000, and UN SDG frameworks.

Audit-ready documentation for management reporting and assurance preparation.

Exclusions

This methodology does not:

Issue formal assurance opinions. Independent auditor review per ISAE 3000 remains required for CSRD limited or reasonable assurance.

Establish causal attribution or calculate social return on investment (SROI).

Provide financial valuation of outcomes.

POSITIONING

Synerxus creates audit-ready verification evidence for ESG and impact claims. We support assurance preparation — we do not replace independent assurance providers.

2. Verification Principles

Synerxus verification is built on five core principles:

Principle	Definition
Traceability	Every claim links to source evidence with verifiable chain of custody.
Independence	Third-party confirmation by parties external to the claim submitter.
Timeliness	Evidence captured within defined operational windows (maximum 72 hours).
Completeness	All required metadata for audit review is captured at verification.
Reproducibility	Standardized process applied consistently across users and contexts.

These principles align with ISAE 3000 evidence requirements for relevance, reliability, and source documentation.

3. Verification Workflow

The verification process follows five sequential steps:



Step 1: Activity Submission

Who: Program managers, CSR teams, NGO staff, or volunteers.

Required fields:

Field	Description	Required
Outcome description	What was accomplished	Yes
Beneficiary count	Number of individuals or entities served	Yes
SDG / ESRS tag	Framework alignment	Yes
Date / time completed	When the activity occurred	Yes
Location	Where the activity occurred	Optional

Validation includes plausibility checks and duplicate detection.

Step 2: Verification Request

Trigger: Sent automatically following activity submission.

Channels: SMS, app notification, or email based on verifier preference.

Content: One-line outcome summary with confirm or reject option.

Step 3: Third-Party Confirmation

Who: NGO staff, employers, beneficiaries, or program leads — parties independent of the submitter.

Process: Single-tap confirmation or rejection with optional comment.

Time: Verification can be completed within 15 seconds. Maximum verification window is 72 hours.

Identity capture: Phone number, device ID, and role verification.

INDEPENDENCE REQUIREMENT

The verifier must be independent of the claim submitter. Self-verification is not permitted. This separation is foundational to evidence reliability.

Step 4: Evidence Capsule Creation

Upon confirmation, the system generates a machine-readable evidence object (JSON) containing:

Claim details (outcome, beneficiary count, framework tags)

Verification metadata (timestamp, verifier identity, device, geolocation)

Integrity data (content hash, verification signature)

Step 5: Reporting & Review

Formats: PDF report, API export, dashboard view.

Access: No-login PDF links for external sharing; role-based dashboard for internal review.

4. Evidence Object Specification

Each verified outcome produces a structured evidence object. The core structure is:

Evidence Object Structure

```
{
  "claimId": "syn-20260407-001",
  "outcome": "Financial literacy workshop for 47 smallholder farmers",
  "beneficiaryCount": 47,
  "frameworks": {
    "sdgPrimary": "SDG 2 Zero Hunger",
    "esrs": "S3.4 Affected Communities"
  },
  "verification": {
    "confirmedAt": "2026-04-07T14:23:12Z",
    "confirmedBy": {
      "verifierId": "ngo-mariasantos-001",
      "role": "Program Director",
      "contact": "+260971234567"
    },
    "device": {
      "deviceId": "hash:sha256-abc123...",
      "geo": "-1.9403, 29.8739"
    },
    "integrity": {
      "hash": "sha256:def456...",
      "signature": "sms:verified"
    }
  },
  "status": "verified"
}
```

Field Requirements

Field	Status	Description
claimId	Required	Unique identifier for the claim
outcome	Required	Description of what was accomplished
beneficiaryCount	Required	Number served
frameworks.sdgPrimary	Required	Primary SDG alignment
frameworks.esrs	Optional	ESRS topic alignment
verification.confirmedAt	Required	ISO 8601 timestamp
verification.confirmedBy	Required	Verifier identity object
verification.device	Required	Device and location metadata
verification.integrity.hash	Required	Content hash for tamper detection
photos	Optional	Supporting imagery
comments	Optional	Additional context

5. Integrity and Review Controls

Identity Controls

Phone number validation confirms verifier identity.

Role-based permissions restrict access by user type.

Device fingerprinting provides additional identity assurance.

Time Controls

Maximum verification window of 72 hours from activity submission.

Timestamp validation ensures chronological consistency.

Late verifications are flagged for review.

Data Controls

Duplicate detection based on claim ID and outcome matching.

Plausibility checks compare beneficiary counts against historical patterns.

Geolocation reasonableness validates verifier proximity to activity location.

Exception Handling

Condition	Action
Rejected claim	Routed to manual review queue
Missing metadata	Flagged for completion before export
Fraud signals detected	Held for investigation
Late verification	Accepted with late flag in evidence object
Duplicate submission	Blocked with notification to submitter

6. Standards Alignment

The Synerxus Verification Methodology aligns with established ESG reporting and assurance standards:

Standard	Synerxus Support
ISAE 3000	Evidence relevance, completeness, and source documentation for assurance preparation
CSRD / ESRS	S3 and S4 community impact evidence trails with structured metadata
GRI Standards	Outcome verification supporting GRI 413 (Local Communities) and GRI 418 (Customer Privacy)
UN SDGs	SDG-aligned outcome tagging with primary and secondary goal mapping
Audit Trail Requirements	Tamper-evident chain of custody with content hashing

ASSURANCE RELATIONSHIP

Synerxus creates the evidence. Independent auditors provide the assurance. For CSRD limited or reasonable assurance, auditor review per ISAE 3000 remains required.

7. Governance

Roles

Role	Responsibility
Submitter	Records activity and outcome claims
Verifier	Confirms or rejects outcomes (independent third party)
Reviewer	Handles exceptions and disputed claims
Admin	Manages users, permissions, and reporting

Data Lifecycle

Phase	Details
Collection	Real-time capture at submission and verification
Retention	Minimum 7 years for audit compliance
Export	PDF, JSON, and CSV formats supported
Deletion	GDPR-compliant deletion upon request with audit log retention

Dispute Resolution

30-day review window for disputed claims.

Full evidence audit log available for review.

Escalation path to program administrator for unresolved disputes.

8. Sample Verified Record

The following illustrates a completed verification record:

VERIFIED OUTCOME

Claim: Financial literacy workshop served 47 smallholder farmers

Status: **Verified**

Verifier: Maria Santos, Program Director

Verified: 2026-04-07 14:23 UTC

Location: Lusaka, Zambia

SDG: SDG 2 Zero Hunger

Evidence Hash: sha256:def456...

9. Limitations and Assurance Boundaries

The Synerxus Verification Methodology operates within defined boundaries:

What This Methodology Provides

Structured evidence collection and organization.

Third-party confirmation workflows.

Audit-ready documentation with chain of custody.

Support for assurance preparation.

What This Methodology Does Not Provide

Formal assurance opinions. Independent auditor review per ISAE 3000 remains required for CSRD limited or reasonable assurance.

Causal attribution or proof of causality between activities and outcomes.

Financial valuation or SROI calculations.

Guarantee of outcome validity — verification quality depends on partner participation.

BOUNDARY STATEMENT

Synerxus creates audit-ready verification evidence. We support assurance preparation and reduce evidence-gathering friction. We do not replace independent assurance providers or guarantee regulatory compliance.

Organizations using Synerxus evidence for CSRD or other regulatory reporting should engage independent assurance providers for formal assurance opinions.

10. Version History

Version	Date	Changes
1.0	April 2026	Initial release

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<https://www.synerxus.com>